



JAN INTAKE · SEPTEMBER 2026 – JANUARY 2027

Study in Switzerland

17 leading Swiss institutions including ETH Zurich and EPFL, tuition from CHF 435–4,000/semester, and a strong concentration of English-taught Master's programmes.

Schengen (Non-EU)

17 Institutions Shown

World-Class Universities

3wk–3mo Processing

English-Taught Master's

Switzerland at a Glance

TUITION (NON-EU)

CHF 435–4,000 / semester

Federal institutes (ETH Zurich, EPFL) charge the most (CHF 2,190/semester) but far below UK/US/Australia levels overall

VISA PROCESSING (PAKISTAN)

At least 8 weeks before entry

Apply for the permit as soon as the acceptance letter arrives — permit processing itself takes 4–8 weeks

APPLICATION DEADLINE (NON-EU)

~28 Feb – 30 April 2026

Typical window for 2026/27 — verify per institution

FASTEST / SLOWEST PROCESSING

3 weeks (Geneva) – 12 weeks (EPFL)

University of Geneva is fastest (official, up to 3 weeks); EPFL slowest (official, 8–12 weeks) — see Visa & Timing page

INSTITUTIONS COVERED

17 shown (10 fully profiled)

Switzerland has ~35 public institutions total (cantonal universities, 2 federal institutes, FH/HES, PH) — this deck covers the most relevant for international students

LANGUAGE

C1 English (universities) / B2 (FH/PH)

Bachelor's mostly in German/French/Italian; Master's at STEM-focused universities almost entirely English

Institutions Overview (1/2)

INSTITUTION	CITY	TUITION (NON-EU/YEAR)	APPLICATION DEADLINE
Bern University of Applied Sciences	Bern, Biel, Bur...	CHF 2,550/semester (from...	See admissions page
EPFL	Lausanne	CHF 2,190/semester	15 December 2025 –...
ETH Zurich	Zurich	CHF 2,190/semester	15 December 2025 –...
PH Bern	Bern	CHF 750/semester	See admissions page
University of Basel	Basel	CHF 850/semester	See admissions page
University of Bern	Bern	CHF 2,550/semester	See admissions page
University of Fribourg	Fribourg	CHF 870/semester	See admissions page
University of Geneva	Geneva	CHF 435/semester	See admissions page
University of Lausanne	Lausanne	CHF 500/semester	See admissions page
University of Lucerne	Lucerne	CHF 1,025/semester	See admissions page
University of Neuchâtel	Neuchâtel	CHF 775/semester	See admissions page
University of St. Gallen	St. Gallen	CHF 3,103/semester (Bache...	30 April 2026
University of Teacher Education Bern	Bern	See admissions page	See admissions page

Institutions Overview (2/2)

INSTITUTION	CITY	TUITION (NON-EU/YEAR)	APPLICATION DEADLINE
University of Teacher Education Lucerne	Lucerne	See admissions page	See admissions page
University of Zurich	Zurich	CHF 1,220/semester (Bache...	See admissions page
Università della Svizzera italiana	Lugano	CHF 4,000/semester	30 April 2026
ZHAW Zurich University of Applied Scien...	Winterthur, Zur...	CHF 1,500–2,500/semester...	30 April 2026

7 institutions (University of Basel, University of Bern, University of Fribourg, University of Lausanne, University of Lucerne, University of Neuchâtel, PH Bern) are shown for tuition reference only — no confirmed course list or website is available in the source research yet.

Websites & Admissions Portals (1/2)

INSTITUTION	OFFICIAL WEBSITE	INTERNATIONAL / ADMISSIONS PORTAL
Bern University of Applied Sciences	https://www.bfh.ch/en/	https://www.bfh.ch/en/studies/application/
EPFL	https://www.epfl.ch/en/	https://www.epfl.ch/education/admission/
ETH Zurich	https://ethz.ch/en.html	https://ethz.ch/en/studies/application.html
PH Bern	—	—
University of Basel	—	—
University of Bern	—	—
University of Fribourg	—	—
University of Geneva	https://www.unige.ch/en/	https://www.unige.ch/immatriculations/
University of Lausanne	—	—
University of Lucerne	—	—
University of Neuchâtel	—	—
University of St. Gallen	https://www.unisg.ch/en/	https://www.unisg.ch/en/studies/admission/
University of Teacher Education Bern	https://www.phbern.ch/en	https://www.phbern.ch/en/studies/

Websites & Admissions Portals (2/2)

INSTITUTION	OFFICIAL WEBSITE	INTERNATIONAL / ADMISSIONS PORTAL
University of Teacher Education Luc...	https://www.phlu.ch/en/	https://www.phlu.ch/en/studies/
University of Zurich	https://www.uzh.ch/en.html	https://www.uzh.ch/en/studies/application.html
Università della Svizzera italiana	https://www.usi.ch/en	https://www.usi.ch/en/education/application
ZHAW Zurich University of Applied S...	https://www.zhaw.ch/en/university/	https://www.zhaw.ch/en/studies/application/

Available Courses (1/4)

Bern University of Applied Sciences

<https://www.bfh.ch/en/>

No English-taught bachelor's programmes listed in source data.

Master's Programmes (2)

MSc in Life Sciences – Agricultural Science · 1.5 years

MSc in Engineering · 1.5 years

EPFL

<https://www.epfl.ch/en/>

No English-taught bachelor's programmes listed in source data.

Master's Programmes (14)

MSc in Computer Science · 2 years

MSc in Data Science · 2 years

MSc in Cybersecurity · 2 years

MSc in Communication Systems · 2 years

MSc in Life Sciences Engineering · 2 years

MSc in Electrical and Electronic Engineering · 2 years

MSc in Materials Science and Engineering · 2 years

MSc in Energy Science and Technology · 2 years

MSc in Robotics · 2 years

MSc in Environmental Sciences and Engineering · 2 years

MSc in Financial Engineering · 2 years

MSc in Sustainable Management and Technology · 2 years

MSc in Architecture · 2 years

MSc in Civil Engineering · 2 years

Available Courses — continued (2/4)

ETH Zurich

<https://ethz.ch/en.html>

No English-taught bachelor's programmes listed in source data.

Master's Programmes (20)

MSc in Computer Science · 2 years

MSc in Data Science · 2 years

MSc in Quantitative Finance · 2 years

MSc in Robotics, Systems and Control · 2 years

MSc in Physics · 2 years

MSc in Chemistry · 2 years

MSc in Chemical and Bioengineering · 2 years

MSc in Biomedical Engineering · 2 years

MSc in Mechanical Engineering · 2 years

MSc in Environmental Engineering · 2 years

MSc in Civil Engineering · 2 years

MSc in Geomatics · 2 years

MSc in Applied Geophysics · 2 years

MSc in Agricultural Sciences · 2 years

+ 6 more in source data

University of Geneva

<https://www.unige.ch/en/>

No English-taught bachelor's programmes listed in source data.

Master's Programmes (4)

MSc in Neuroscience · 2 years

MAS in Humanitarian Studies · 1 year

MSc in Statistics · 2 years

LL.M. in International Business Law · 1 year

Available Courses — continued (3/4)

University of St. Gallen

<https://www.unisg.ch/en/>

No English-taught bachelor's programmes listed in source data.

Master's Programmes (8)

MSc in Strategy and International Management (SIM)

MSc in Quantitative Economics and Finance (MiQE/F) · 2 years

MSc in Banking and Finance (MBF) · 90 ECTS

MSc in Computer Science (MCS) · 2 years

MSc in Business Innovation (MBI) · 90 ECTS

MSc in Marketing Management (MiMM) · 90 ECTS

MSc in General Management (MGM) · 90 ECTS

MBA (The St. Gallen MBA)

University of Zurich

<https://www.uzh.ch/en.html>

No English-taught bachelor's programmes listed in source data.

Master's Programmes (6)

MSc UZH ETH in Quantitative Finance · 2 years

MA in English Literature and Linguistics · 2 years

MSc in Biostatistics · 2 years

MSc in Theoretical Astrophysics and Cosmology · 2 years

MA in Modern Asian and Middle Eastern Studies · 2 years

MSc in Finance (NEW 2026) · 2 years

Available Courses — continued (4/4)

Università della Svizzera italiana

<https://www.usi.ch/en>

No English-taught bachelor's programmes listed in source data.

Master's Programmes (5)

MSc in Public Management and Policy · 2 years

MSc in Informatics · 2 years

MSc in Economics · 2 years

MSc in Finance · 2 years

MSc in Management · 2 years

ZHAW Zurich University of Applied Sciences

<https://www.zhaw.ch/en/university/>

No English-taught bachelor's programmes listed in source data.

Master's Programmes (4)

MSc in Engineering · 1.5 years

MSc in Life Sciences · 1.5 years

MSc in Management and Law · 1.5 years

MSc in Applied Psychology · 1.5 years

Visa Process & Application Timing

OFFICIAL PROCESSING TIMES

- **University of Geneva:** up to 3 weeks (fastest, official)
- **University of Bern:** 6–8 weeks (official)
- **ETH Zurich:** within 8 weeks (official)
- **EPFL:** 8–12 weeks, notifications March–April (official, slowest)
- Other cantonal/FH/PH institutions: 4–8 weeks (unofficial, student-forum sourced)

VISA PROCESSING (PAKISTAN)

- Apply for the student permit as soon as the acceptance letter is received
- Permit processing: **4–8 weeks**
- Budget **at least 8 weeks** total before intended entry date

COUNSELOR NOTE

Bachelor's-level English-taught programmes are rare in Switzerland — guide students without German/French/Italian toward English-taught Master's programmes, particularly at ETH Zurich, EPFL, University of Zurich, and University of St. Gallen. A UZH–ETH joint Master's in Quantitative Finance and an ETH–EPFL joint programme in Cybersecurity are notable cross-institution options.

Deadlines, Eligibility & Gap/Age Policy

APPLICATION DEADLINES — SPRING/AUTUMN 2027

- University of Geneva Spring 2027: applications open 15 Sep 2026; deadline 30 Nov 2026 (no visa needed) or 28 Feb 2027 (visa required).
- University of Basel Spring 2027: applications open 15 Oct 2026, deadline 30 Nov 2026.
- ETH Zurich Autumn 2027 (foreign certificates): application window 1 Dec 2026 – 31 Mar 2027.
- HSLU: Spring 2027 deadline 15 Jan 2027; Autumn 2027 deadline 15 Aug 2027.

GRADE & SUBJECT-MARK ELIGIBILITY

- ETH Zurich: HSC plus university-admission certificate plus a passing score on the Reduced Entrance Examination ETHZ — this exam is specifically required for Pakistani applicants.
- University of Geneva (Bachelor's): three strong option exams including one science subject, plus three medium option exams.
- IMI Luzern: HSC with at least 60% is sufficient for Pakistani applicants — one of the more accessible pathways in the country.

PAKISTAN-SPECIFIC REQUIREMENTS

- ETH Zurich's Reduced Entrance Exam is the main gatekeeper for Pakistani Bachelor's applicants — budget serious prep time for it.
- Foreign qualifications may additionally require the Swiss Federal Baccalaureate Examination depending on the institution.

STUDY GAP & AGE POLICY

No unified federal gap-year policy — each university sets its own rule; Bachelor's typically tolerates 1–2 years, Master's up to 5 years. No universal age ceiling, but several alternative-admission routes carry their own minimums: University of Bern 30+, University of Geneva and Lausanne 25+ with 3 years' professional experience, USI Lugano 25+ without formal qualifications. General minimum entry age is 18.

FEE RANGE CROSS-CHECK

Public: CHF 435–4,000/semester (federal institutes ETH Zurich/EPFL sit at the top of that range, CHF 2,190/semester). Private: CHF 12,000–42,535/year. Application fee: CHF 100–150.

University-Specific Eligibility Requirements (1/2)

INSTITUTION	LEVEL	OVERALL GRADE REQUIREMENT	SUBJECT-SPECIFIC REQUIREMENTS	STANDARDISED TESTS	ENTRANCE EXAMS
ETH Zurich	UG	HSC + uni admission + minimum grades defined...	Mathematics, Physics	Not required	Reduced Entrance E...
ETH Zurich	PG	Relevant bachelor's	STEM	Not required	Not required
EPFL	UG	Secondary certificate	Mathematics, Physics	Not required	Entrance exam
EPFL	PG	Relevant bachelor's	STEM	Not required	Not required
University of Zurich	PG	Minimum overall grade 5 (Swiss scale 1–6; 4 =...	Programme-specific	Not required	Not required
ZHAW	PG (Engi...	Swiss grades A or B (top 35%); CGPA ≥80% for...	Engineering/Science	Not required	Not required
University of Geneva	UG	Three strong option exams including one scien...	Science subject mandatory	Not required	Not required
University of St. Gallen	PG	Relevant bachelor's	Business/Economics	GMAT/GRE	Not required
IMI Luzern	UG	Pakistan: HSC with ≥60%	Programme-specific	Not required	Not required

University-Specific Eligibility Requirements (2/2)

INSTITUTION	LEVEL	OVERALL GRADE REQUIREMENT	SUBJECT-SPECIFIC REQUIREMENTS	STANDARDISED TESTS	ENTRANCE EXAMS
FHNW	PG	Relevant bachelor's	Programme-specific	Not required	Not required
HES-SO	PG	Relevant bachelor's	Programme-specific	Not required	Not required

PAKISTAN-SPECIFIC NOTES

- ETH Zurich: Pakistani applicants require HSC + certificate of university admission + Reduced Entrance Exam ETHZ
- IMI Luzern: HSC with at least 60%
- Foreign qualifications may require Swiss Federal Baccalaureate Examination
- English: IELTS 7.0+ / TOEFL iBT 100+ for top universities
- French B2/C1 for EPFL bachelor's

Documents Checklist

GENERAL APPLICATION DOCUMENTS

- Passport (first 2 pages, scanned)
- Academic transcripts — Matric through Bachelor's
- Degree certificates (all levels)
- CV / Europass format
- Motivation letter / SOP
- English language certificate (IELTS/equivalent)
- Recommendation letters (program-dependent)
- Proof of funds / tuition payment evidence

Quote Carefully — Corrections & Safeguards

CORRECTIONS & SAFEGUARDS — DO NOT OVERSTATE

- English-taught Bachelor's programmes are genuinely rare in Switzerland — do not imply broad English-medium Bachelor's availability; it is mainly a Master's-level option, concentrated at research universities and federal institutes.
- Processing times vary hugely by institution (3 weeks to 3 months) — never quote a single Switzerland-wide timeline; always name the specific institution.
- 7 institutions (University of Basel, University of Bern, University of Fribourg, University of Lausanne...) appear only in the tuition-fee table with no confirmed course list or website in the source research — they are shown for tuition reference only, not full profiles; do not present them as fully researched.
- Unofficial turnaround estimates (student forums) should be flagged clearly as unofficial if quoted.
- Switzerland is outside the EU/Schengen visa-free zone in some respects but is a Schengen member — confirm current visa category requirements per canton before advising.